

REFERENCE
CP-GOLIVE-2026-01

ISSUED
1 August 2026

PREPARED FOR
CheqPay — Founder

Read this first

This is a planning estimate for launching CheqPay in production — it is not an invoice from any vendor and no money is owed to anyone on the strength of this document. Vendor list prices are current published rates and are reliable. Everything under Sections E and F is **not** reliable: those figures move, are negotiated per-merchant, or depend on a regulatory category CheqPay has not yet been assigned. Treat them as placeholders to be replaced by written quotes.

A. Recurring infrastructure — monthly (USD)

Everything here is a published list price. These are the running costs of the stack CheqPay already uses.

Item	What it covers	Per month
Render — API service	Starter instance, Frankfurt. Hosts apps/api . This is the line that buys the static outbound IP Maplerad requires for whitelisting — the reason the API leaves Vercel at all.	\$7.00
Render — cron job	Daily price-alert job. Replaces Vercel Cron, which does not follow the API off Vercel.	~\$1.00
Vercel Pro	Web app (cheqpy) and admin dashboard (cheqpay-admin). Pro is required: the Hobby tier prohibits commercial use. Billed per seat.	\$20.00
Supabase Pro	Postgres + Auth. Pro is not optional for a custodial ledger: the free tier auto-pauses the project and has no daily backups.	\$25.00
Resend	Transaction alerts, statement delivery, OTP mail. Free to 3,000 emails/month; Pro at 50,000.	\$0 – \$20.00
Sentry — Team	Error and performance monitoring. Already wired via instrumentation.ts ; DSN-guarded, so it is dark until paid for.	\$26.00
Anthropic API	In-app AI support agent. Usage-based; falls back to a static FAQ responder when unset, so this is genuinely optional at launch.	~\$20.00
Expo EAS — Production (<i>optional</i>)	Managed build queue and over-the-air updates. The free tier works at low build volume; the paid plan buys build concurrency and priority.	\$0 – \$99.00
Monthly run rate — lean / full		\$99 – \$218

B. Store, domain and one-time technical costs

Item	What it covers	Amount
Apple Developer Program	Mandatory to ship on the App Store. Renews annually; a lapse pulls the app from sale.	\$99.00 / yr

Item	What it covers	Amount
Google Play Developer	One-time registration. Note the Financial Features Declaration is required for a wallet app — no fee, but it demands the licence documentation from Section E.	\$25.00 once
Domain — cheqpay.com	Also needed for Resend sender-domain verification (MAIL_FROM must be on a verified domain).	~\$15.00 / yr
Independent security assessment	Penetration test of the custodial flows. Not legally mandatory on day one, but a custodial wallet holding customer funds without one is an uninsurable risk, and partners increasingly ask for the report.	\$5,000 – \$15,000

C. Year-one technology total

Item	What it covers	Year 1
Lean configuration	Free Resend and EAS tiers, no AI support agent, no security assessment. Enough to be live and correct.	~\$1,330
Full configuration	Every service on its paid tier, excluding the security assessment.	~\$2,755
Full + security assessment	Recommended for a service holding customer funds.	\$7,755 – \$17,755

The headline

The technology is cheap — under \$200 a month runs the entire platform. The cost of going live is almost entirely licensing, compliance and float, and those are the numbers this document cannot responsibly give you.

D. Per-transaction and usage-based — quote required

These are negotiated per merchant. None can be taken from a public price list; all need a written quote.

Item	What it covers	Cost
Maplerad — onboarding	Account opening, compliance review, live-key issuance. Also the gate on NGN collections , which Maplerad has not yet enabled — without it users cannot fund accounts at all.	Quote
Maplerad — NGN collections	Per-deposit fee on dedicated virtual accounts.	Quote
Maplerad — payouts	Per-transfer fee on bank payouts and withdrawals.	Quote
Maplerad — bill payments	Airtime, data, electricity, cable. Commission-based; confirm whether it is a rebate or a charge.	Quote
Maplerad — virtual cards	Card issuance fee, monthly maintenance, FX markup, and any BIN sponsorship minimum. Typically the most expensive line in this table.	Quote
Dojah — KYC / BVN	Per successful verification. Currently KYC_PROVIDER=mock ; this becomes a real per-user cost the day it flips to live.	Quote
Expo push notifications	Expo's push service is free at CheqPay's volume.	\$0
Binance / CoinGecko price feeds	Public endpoints, free tier. CoinGecko is already the fallback if Binance rate-limits.	\$0

E. Regulatory and compliance — Nigeria (figures NOT verified)

Do not budget from this section

CheqPay custodies customer funds and facilitates crypto–fiat conversion, which puts it inside Nigeria's digital-asset regime. The applicable category, capital requirement and fee schedule depend on how the SEC classifies the business — a determination only Nigerian fintech counsel can make. The amounts below are deliberately left open rather than guessed at, because a wrong number here is worse than no number.

Item	What it covers	Amount
SEC Nigeria — VASP / digital asset registration	Filing, processing and registration fees for the applicable category. Confirm whether CheqPay falls under a full registration or an incubation/sandbox route — the difference is very large.	Confirm
Minimum paid-up capital	Digital asset categories carry a capital floor in the hundreds of millions of naira. This is locked capital, not a fee, and is usually the single biggest barrier to launching.	Confirm
Fidelity bond / insurance	Typically expressed as a percentage of paid-up capital.	Confirm
CBN position on the naira rail	The NGN side runs through Maplerad's licence rather than CheqPay's. Confirm in writing that Maplerad's licence covers CheqPay's model — relying on a partner's licence without that letter is a live risk.	Confirm
NDPC registration (NDPA 2023)	Data controller registration, a named Data Protection Officer, and the annual compliance audit filing. CheqPay processes BVNs, so this is not optional.	Confirm
Legal counsel	Licensing application, terms of service, privacy policy, AML/CFT policy manual. Budget for a retainer, not a one-off fee.	Confirm
CAC company registration	If the operating entity is not already incorporated.	Confirm

F. Working capital — not an expense

This is money that stays yours but cannot be spent on anything else. Under-sizing it is the most common way a wallet fails in its first month.

Item	What it covers	Sizing
Maplerad NGN float	Prefunded balance covering payouts and bill payments between settlement cycles. Size to peak daily outflow, not average — a float that empties mid-day means failed withdrawals and a support queue.	Volume-based
Crypto liquidity (USDT)	Inventory backing user buy orders. The SWAP_SPREAD_BPS margin (currently 150 bps) is only earned if there is inventory to sell.	Volume-based
Cashback reserve	The admin-configured cashback rate is a direct cost of every transaction. At 0.5% on NGN 10m monthly volume that is NGN 50,000/month, paid out of margin.	Rate × volume
Chargeback / reversal buffer	Failed payouts, reversed bills and disputed card transactions need funding before recovery.	Volume-based

Summary — what can actually be planned today

Item	What it covers	Amount
Monthly run rate	Section A. Published list prices, no negotiation required. This number is firm.	\$99 – \$218
Year-one technology	Sections A–C, excluding the security assessment. Also firm.	\$1,330 – \$2,755
Per-transaction economics	Section D. Unknown until Maplerad and Dojah quote. Determines whether the 150 bps spread is actually profitable — this is the number that decides if the business model works.	Unknown
Licensing and capital	Sections E and F. Unknown until counsel advises. Almost certainly larger than every other line on this document combined.	Unknown

Basis of estimate

- **Scope.** Costs to run the CheqPay platform as it exists in this repository: Next.js API, web app, admin dashboard and Expo mobile app, with Maplerad as the payments and custody rail.
- **Currency.** Sections A–D are USD, as those vendors bill in USD. Section E is naira-denominated and deliberately unconverted — no exchange-rate assumption is embedded anywhere in this document.
- **Confidence.** Sections A–C are published list prices and are reliable. Section D is negotiated and unknowable without a quote. Section E is **not verified** and must be replaced with counsel's figures before it informs any decision.
- **Excluded.** Salaries, contractor time, marketing, customer support staffing, office and equipment, accountancy, and corporate tax. This covers the cost of *running the software and being allowed to operate*, nothing else.
- **Not included as a cost.** Section F is capital, not expenditure — it is listed because a launch plan that omits it will fail regardless of how well the technology budget is managed.

Suggested next step

Get written quotes for Section D from Maplerad and Dojah, and an engagement letter from Nigerian fintech counsel covering Section E. Until those two arrive, the only number in this document you can actually plan around is the ~\$99–\$218/month in Section A.